

Bharat MCP — Non-Technical Requirements

Bangalore Pilot: Partnerships, Payments, Platform Access & Delivery

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This document covers everything the pilot needs that isn't engineering — restaurant partnerships, payment settlement, registering with the AI platforms, delivery, legal compliance, and support. It complements the FRD (functional requirements) and the infra plan (technical architecture).

1. Restaurant Partnerships & Onboarding

1.1 Sourcing strategy: chains vs. independents

Two parallel tracks, not one: - **Independent long-tail restaurants** — the core 500 target, sourced by the interns via direct outreach (per the earlier pilot estimate). - **Local/regional chains** (e.g., multi-outlet Bangalore brands not fully committed to Swiggy/Zomato, or willing to run a parallel direct channel) — one negotiation can add 5–15 restaurants at once, and a chain is more likely to have someone who can make a decision quickly than a single-owner independent. Worth a short list of 10–15 candidate chains approached in parallel with the independent-restaurant funnel, not sequentially after it.

1.2 Commercial terms with restaurants

A decision is needed before outreach scales past the first pilot batch: - Is onboarding free during the pilot (to maximize sign-up rate), or is there a token fee/commission from day one to test willingness-to-pay? - If a commission is charged later, what rate — and is it lower than the 20–30% Swiggy/Zomato take, since “lower cost than the aggregator” is the core pitch to a restaurant already listed elsewhere? - A simple one-page onboarding agreement is needed either way: what the restaurant agrees to (accurate menu/pricing, timely order acceptance), what the platform commits to (no exclusivity demand, restaurant can leave anytime), and the consent language for listing them to AI agents.

1.3 Verification requirements per restaurant

- Valid FSSAI license (mandatory for any food business in India) — collect and verify before going live, not just menu/hours.
 - GST registration details, if the restaurant is registered (affects invoicing on orders).
 - A named point of contact and a WhatsApp/phone number that's actually monitored during business hours — this is what the whole relay model depends on.
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2. Payment & Settlement

2.1 Payment aggregator relationship

A commercial agreement with a licensed Payment Aggregator (Razorpay or Cashfree) is needed, not just an API key. This involves: - Business KYC (company registration documents, PAN, GST, bank account) submitted to the PSP. - A merchant/sub-merchant or marketplace settlement setup — since money flows customer → platform → restaurant, this needs to run through the PSP's nodal/escrow account structure. Under RBI's Payment Aggregator rules, a platform collecting payment on behalf of multiple merchants generally cannot hold funds directly without routing through a licensed PA's escrow mechanism — this is why using a licensed PSP (rather than a plain payment gateway) matters here, and it's worth a direct conversation with the PSP's onboarding team to confirm the correct account structure for a marketplace model before building against it. - Settlement cycle to restaurants (e.g., T+1 or T+2) needs to be agreed and clearly communicated to restaurant owners as part of onboarding.

2.2 Refunds & disputes

- A written refund policy (order not fulfilled, wrong item, restaurant rejection after payment) — who authorizes a refund, and how fast.
- A dispute path for a restaurant that disputes non-payment or a customer that disputes non-delivery — even at pilot scale, this needs an owner, not an ad hoc decision each time.

2.3 Cash-on-delivery

COD needs no PSP relationship but does need a reconciliation process — someone has to confirm restaurants actually collected what was ordered, since there's no digital record of a cash handoff.

3. AI Platform / MCP Registration

3.1 Developer/partner registration

Each AI platform (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google) has its own process for registering an MCP server as a connector — this is a business/account-setup step independent of the engineering work, and timelines are not fully in your control: - Business verification / developer account setup per platform. - Review of terms of service — data handling commitments, what the platform requires you to disclose to end users, any restrictions on commission structures or how orders may be presented. - Confirm whether there is a fee, revenue share, or purely a technical listing with no commercial terms

attached — this varies by platform and is worth confirming directly rather than assuming free/open access. - Build in approval-queue time as a schedule risk — this is the one dependency in the whole pilot most likely to sit outside your team’s control, so start this in parallel with restaurant onboarding, not after the tech is built.

3.2 Data-sharing terms

Understand what customer data (name, phone, order contents) the platform expects to pass through, and what you’re allowed to retain versus must pass through only — this affects both the privacy policy (below) and what the admin panel is allowed to store long-term.

4. Delivery & Fulfillment

This is the single biggest open decision for the pilot and should be resolved early, since it changes the entire operating model.

4.1 Option A — Pickup/dine-in only for pilot

Simplest to run: no delivery logistics needed at all, restaurant fulfills the order for pickup or the customer eats in. Removes an entire category of partnership and cost from the pilot, at the cost of a narrower use case (an AI agent “ordering food” that the user still has to walk over and collect is a weaker pitch than true delivery).

4.2 Option B — Restaurant’s own delivery staff

Works only for restaurants that already have their own delivery riders (common for chains, rarer for small independents). No new partner needed, but coverage will be inconsistent across the 500.

4.3 Option C — Third-party hyperlocal delivery partner

A commercial/API tie-up with an on-demand logistics provider (e.g., Shadowfax, Borzo, Porter, Dunzo-style API) to fetch and deliver orders for restaurants without their own fleet. Requires: - A commercial agreement and rate card (typically per-delivery pricing, distance-based). - API access for order dispatch and live tracking, so `get_order_status` can reflect real delivery state. - Coverage check — confirm the partner actually services the specific Bangalore neighborhoods chosen for the pilot before committing.

Recommendation: decide this before restaurant outreach scales past the first 50, since it changes what you’re actually promising restaurants and customers. Starting with Option A (pickup-only) for the first 50–100 restaurants to validate the ordering flow itself, then layering in a delivery partner once the core loop works, is a reasonable way to de-risk this without blocking the pilot on a logistics contract upfront.

5. Legal & Compliance

- **FSSAI** — verify license for every onboarded restaurant (see 1.3).
- **GST invoicing** — orders need compliant invoices where the restaurant is GST-registered; decide whether the platform or the restaurant issues the invoice.
- **Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020** — as a marketplace connecting buyers and sellers, standard e-commerce obligations apply: displaying seller (restaurant) details, a grievance redressal contact, and clear return/refund/cancellation terms to the end customer.
- **Data privacy (DPDP Act, 2023)** — customer contact info and order data collected through the platform needs a privacy policy covering what’s collected, why, and for how long, plus basic consent language, since this is personal data under the Act.
- **Terms of Service & Privacy Policy** — needed as published documents before real customer orders flow, not just an internal agreement with restaurants.

6. Customer Support & Operations

- A support channel for order issues during the pilot — realistically the interns/lead handling this manually via WhatsApp/phone at this scale, but it needs an explicit owner and response-time expectation, not an ad hoc catch-as-catch-can approach.
- A simple SOP: what happens when an order is rejected after payment, when a restaurant doesn’t respond, when a customer disputes an order — each needs a documented default action, not a judgment call made fresh each time.

7. Ownership & Cost Summary

Workstream	Suggested owner	Notes
Restaurant chain outreach	Founder’s office (Amit) or senior intern	Needs decision-maker-level conversations, distinct from independent-restaurant legwork
Independent restaurant onboarding	2 interns	Covered in the earlier ops estimate
Payment aggregator relationship	Founder’s office	KYC and marketplace account structure need a signatory, not an intern
MCP/AI platform registration	Founder’s office + infra lead	Business terms + technical registration both

		needed
Delivery partner negotiation	Founder’s office	Commercial agreement + rate card
Legal (T&Cs, privacy policy, FSSAI/GST checks)	External counsel or a template-based DIY pass for pilot scale	Budget for at least a review pass by counsel before real transactions go live
Customer support during pilot	Interns, escalating to lead	No dedicated hire needed at 500-restaurant pilot volume

Non-infra cost additions to budget for: legal review/drafting (one-time, likely ₹15k–40k for a lightweight T&Cs/privacy-policy/FSSAI-check pass), delivery partner per-order fees if Option C is chosen (variable, ask for their rate card directly), and any restaurant onboarding incentive already flagged in the ops estimate.

8. Gating Dependencies (what blocks what)

- Payment aggregator KYC/account setup should start immediately — this has the longest external lead time and blocks any real (non-COD) transaction.
- AI platform registration should start immediately in parallel — approval timelines are outside your control and are a genuine schedule risk if left until the tech is “ready.”
- The delivery model decision (Section 4) should be made before restaurant outreach passes ~50 restaurants, since it changes what’s being promised to each new restaurant onboarded after that point.
- Legal documents (T&Cs, privacy policy) are needed before any real customer order — not before restaurant onboarding, which can proceed on the agreement in 1.2 alone.

9. Key Risks (non-technical)

- **Payment aggregator marketplace/escrow setup takes longer than expected** — start this conversation now, not after the tech is built.
- **AI platform approval delays the go-live date** independent of how ready the engineering is.
- **No delivery partner in place** turns the pilot into pickup-only by default, which may undercut the core value proposition if not explicitly chosen as the pilot’s scope.
- **A restaurant accepts an order it can’t fulfill** (no live inventory sync) — this is a trust risk with both the customer and the AI platform if it happens repeatedly; the accept/reject relay step (FR-15) is what’s meant to catch this, but it depends on restaurants actually responding promptly.